

School: Barford Primary

Date: 04/05/23

Report: Onsite audit walk **DPE consultant:** Stuart Lee (SL) **School :** Carla Steadman (CS)

An onsite visit took place on the 4th May 2023. This was arranged to complete a physical audit of the school. The school is part of the Wymondham Cluster. SL provides GDPR updates to KH (Robert Kett) who then drip feeds to each school. CS has just taken on the executive head role and is currently updating compliance documents and is still working through physical and electronic data.

Audit walk feedback

Good practice was observed with minimal data on display. Folder and online systems used for sharing data securely. CPOMS is used for Safeguarding. Each classroom has a lockable cupboard/cabinet. Coatpegs displayed forename only, as did the majority of student class lists. EHCPs and care plans are stored securely.

Moving forward, the school will develop routines for maintaining data in online systems to adhere to data retention guidelines including, the school server. This will be supported by DPE with a data retention workshop.

The following documents/best practice areas on the DPE website can be used to reference against and to obtain additional resources detailed in the report:

- [DPE compliance documents/consent guidance](#)
- [DPE quick reference guide](#)
- [Records management best practice](#)
- [Information and cyber security](#)

Audit walk observations and recommendations are detailed below:

Visitor sign in

Recommendations: Add the following statement to the sign in system: Visitor information is collected for health and safety, record of official visits and safeguarding. If you would like to know more, the general/visitors privacy notice is available on the school website, or you can ask at reception for a paper copy (paper copy could go on the notice board).

Reception office/offices

Positive observation. Areas were clear of clutter. Shredders/bins used for securely destroying sensitive data. Adequate lockable storage.

Leadership team offices

Recommendations:

Continue to complete a data cleanse and securely destroy outdated information.
Consider adding secure code entry to the headteacher/leadership team office.

Photocopiers

Photocopiers had no secure codes.

Recommendation: To minimise the risk of sensitive data being left on photocopiers add a secure printing option to the photocopiers. **CS is currently investigating secure codes.**

Classrooms

Some folders were observed with sensitive data; 1 x password observed on a post-it note, 1 x external personal hard drive and unlocked laptops.

Recommendations:

- Remind staff to add any folders that contain sensitive data (assessment/intervention etc) to available storage.
- Continue to complete a data cleanse of classrooms/cupboards for example, Y3/4 classroom and Reception classrooms.
- Ascertain which staff use their own memory sticks/external hard drives and determine what information is contained on these devices. Utilise the Cloud for sharing rather than portable devices. If it is determined that staff require external memory devices, the school should ban personal external memory devices and purchase their own. The school should also ensure they only contain resources and that devices are encrypted.
- Remind staff to lock laptops when not in their work area and avoid writing down usernames and passwords.

Locking of computers and iPads

There were locations where staff were still logged in but not in their work area and 1 x iPad (FAB kitchen) where SL was able to access school dinner money applications, which included student information.

Recommendations:

- Remind staff to use **Windows key + L** to lock laptops/desktops when not in the work area.
- **Add secure codes to all staff iPads.**
- Consider additional training for staff i.e DPE's [Password nugget training](#).
- Adopt DPEs [Password Policy](#).

Staffroom

Recommendations: Review data in pigeon holes as outdated absence forms etc were observed.

General follow ups

- School to continue to complete a data cleanse and securely destroy outdated information.
- The school can develop start of year data management routines; encouraging staff to self regulate, checking online folders and deleting data no longer needed.
- SL to complete a cluster data retention workshop Autumn term 2023.
- Ensure all staff have completed Stay Safe Online NCSC and GDPR training.
- Continue to complete the NCC cyber security thematic audit action plan (version also attached).
- Review and update compliance documents - SL can support if required.